UU-T-770B
April 22, 1977
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. UU-T-770A
June 26, 1963

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

TUBES, DRINKING (PAPER)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers paper drinking tubes (straws) for hot and cold liquids (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification. The drinking tubes shall be of the following types and lengths, as specified (see 6.2):

Type I - Slim, rigid.
Type II - Jumbo, rigid.

Length - 7-7/8 inches, ± 1/8 inch.

Type III - Jumbo, flexible.

Length - 8-1/4 inches, ± 1/4 inch.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes, Paperboard, Metal Edged and Components.
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

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Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attribute.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

Laws and Regulations:

21 CFR 121.2526 Components of paper and paperboard in contact with aqueous and fatty foods.
21 CFR 121.2546 Pulp from reclaimed fiber.

(The Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) and the Federal Register (FR) are for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402. When indicated reprints of certain regulations may be obtained from Federal agency responsible for issuance thereof.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

U. S. Department of Health, Education and Welfare (HEW):

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The material used for the tubes shall conform to the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

3.1.1 Paper. Tubes shall be made from paper of bleached chemical pulp. Paper used shall conform to 21 CFR 121.2526 for paper and paperboard in contact with aqueous and fatty foods.

3.1.2 Waterproofing. The paper of the tubes shall be treated with wax, plastic, or other suitable waterproofing materials to provide rigidity to the tubes (see 3.5).

3.2 Color. The color of the tubes shall be white.

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3.3 Dimensions.

3.3.1 Inside diameter. The inside diameter of the tubes shall be as shown below:

	Inside diameter - inches		
	Minimum	Nominal	Maximum
Type I	0.140	0.150	0.160
Type II	.207	.217	.227
Type III	.208	.218	.228

3.3.2 Wall thickness. The wall thickness of the tubes shall be within the range of 0.0025 to 0.0029 inch for the type I and 0.0030 to 0.0040 inch for the types II and III.

3.4 Construction, type III. The type III flexible tube shall be 8-1/4 ± 1/4 inches long with one arm 5-3/4 ± 1/8 inches and the other arm 2 ± 1/8 inches long. Between the arms shall be a corrugated section 1/2 inch, minimum, allowing the tube to be adjustable by bending to any angle 65 degrees from the longitudinal axis of the tube. The tube shall retain the angle to which it is bent.

3.5 Rigidity. Tubes shall be rigid and shall not collapse or distort when tested in accordance with 4.4.1.

3.6 Odor and taste. Tubes shall not impart any extraneous odor or taste to the contents to which used (see 4.4.2).

3.7 Wrapping. Tubes shall be individually wrapped or unwrapped, as specified (see 6.2). When individually wrapped, tubes shall be sealed in wrap commonly used in the industry. Commercial colors and markings are acceptable on the wrap.

3.8 Workmanship. The tubes shall be free from defects affecting appearance or serviceability. Tubes shall be clean and ready for use.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Visual and dimensional examination. Samples shall be selected in accordance with level S-3 in MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one tube.

4.2.2 Testing. Samples shall be selected in accordance with level S-1 in MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one tube. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 1.5 percent defective.

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 End item. Tubes selected in 4.2.1 shall be examined for defects listed in table I. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 4.0 percent defective.

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TABLE I. Classification of defects, end item

Examine	Defects
Wrapping (as applicable)	Omitted; not sealed.
Appearance	Color not as specified. Dirt, plastic dust, foreign material. Stained.
Dimensions	Incorrect length. Length of type II arms and flexible section not as specified. Incorrect inside diameter. Incorrect wall thickness.
Construction	Type II flexible section not adjustable as specified.
Workmanship	Rough surface and ends. Tubes crushed permanently out of round. Length not reasonably straight (greater than 1/4-inch bow). Not waterproof treated.

4.3.2 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing, and marking requirements comply with section 5. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table II. For examination of interior packaging, the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery selected at random just prior to the closing operation. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of a closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 percent defective.

TABLE II. Examination of packaging

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Bulging or distortion of container.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Rigidity. Immerse one end of the tube 2-1/2 to 3 inches in heated water at a holding temperature between 140° and 150°F for 5 minutes. The longer arm of the type III tube shall be immersed. Siphon 3 to 4 ounces of the water through the tube to determine compliance with 3.5.

4.4.2 Odor and taste. The liquid in 4.4.1 shall be used to determine compliance with 3.6.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Five hundred tubes of one type only shall be packaged in a close fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665, PPP-B-676. The box shall be closed in accordance with applicable specification or appendix thereto.

5.1.2 Commercial. Tubes shall be preserved-packaged to afford adequate protection against physical damage during shipment from the supplier to the first receiving activity. The package and the quantity per package shall be the same as that normally used by the supplier for retail distribution.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A or commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Fifty type I, twenty-five type II or twenty type III packages, preserved-packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting, fiberboard shipping container conforming to a style RSC, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. Each fiberboard container shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed in accordance with method V, and reinforced as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Commercial. Tubes, preserved-packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. The quantity per shipping container shall be the same as that normally used by the supplier for retail distribution. Containers shall comply with the Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable.

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123 or MIL-STD-129, as applicable.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Tubes are intended for drinking hot or cold liquids. The type III flexible tube is intended to facilitate drinking by bed patients.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type and length of tube (see 1.2).
(c) Whether tube shall be wrapped or unwrapped (see 3.7).
(d) Level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 Supersession data. The classification of the tubes between this revision and the previous edition has been changed. Wrapping of the tubes in now given as an option in 6.2. The lengths as stated in UU-T-770A no longer apply. Comparison of classification types between these documents is as follows:

UU-T-770A	UU-T-770B
Type I - Slim, unwrapped.	Type I - Slim, rigid.
Type II - Jumbo, individually wrapped.	Type II - Jumbo, rigid.
Type III - Jumbo, flexible, unwrapped.	Type III - Jumbo, flexible.
Type IV - Jumbo, flexible, individually wrapped.	Deleted.

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MILITARY INTEREST:

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 99

Review activities:

Army - MD
Air Force - 03

User activity:

Navy - MS

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

GSA-FSS
VA-DMS

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